

165. Chapter 14 Verses 6-10

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 14.6

तत्र सत्त्वं निर्मलत्वात्प्रकाशकमनामयम् ।
सुखसङ्गेन बध्नाति ज्ञानसङ्गेन चानघ ॥ ६ ॥

tatra sattvaṁ nirmalatvāt prakāśhakam anāmayam
sukha-saṅgena badhnāti jñāna-saṅgena chānagha

tatra—amongst these; **sattvam**—mode of goodness; **nirmalatvāt**—being purest; **prakāśhakam**—illuminating; **anāmayam**—healthy and full of well-being; **sukha**—happiness; **saṅgena**—attachment; **badhnāti**—binds; **jñāna**—knowledge; **saṅgena**—attachment; **cha**—also; **anagha**—Arjun, the sinless one

Of these, sattva, being stainless, is luminous and healthful. It binds, O sinless Arjuna, by creating attachment to happiness and attachment to knowledge.

VERSE 14.7

रजो रागात्मकं विद्धि तृष्णासङ्गसमुद्भवम् ।
तन्निबध्नाति कौन्तेय कर्मसङ्गेन देहिनम् ॥ ७ ॥

rajo rāgātmakam viddhi tṛiṣṇā-saṅga-samudbhavam
tan nibadhnāti kaunteya karma-saṅgena dehinam

rajaḥ—mode of passion; **rāga-ātmakam**—of the nature of passion; **viddhi**—know; **tṛiṣṇā**—desires; **saṅga**—association; **samudbhavam**—arises from; **tat**—that; **nibadhnāti**—binds; **kaunteya**—Arjun, the son of Kunti; **karma-saṅgena**—through attachment to fruitive actions; **dehinam**—the embodied soul

Know that rajas is the essence of passion and the cause of thirst and attachment. It binds fast the embodied soul, O son of Kunti, by attachment to action.

VERSE 14.8

तमस्त्वज्ञानजं विद्धि मोहनं सर्वदेहिनाम् ।
प्रमादालस्यनिद्राभिस्तन्निबध्नाति भारत ॥ ८ ॥

tamas tv ajñāna-jam viddhi mohanam sarva-dehinām
pramādālasya-nidrābhis tan nibadhnāti bhārata

tamaḥ—mode of ignorance; **tu**—but; **ajñāna-jam**—born of ignorance; **viddhi**—know; **mohanam**—illusion; **sarva-dehinām**—for all the embodied souls; **pramāda**—negligence; **ālasya**—laziness; **nidrābhiḥ**—sleep; **tat**—that; **nibadhnāti**—binds; **bhārata**—Arjun, the son of Bharat

And know further that **tamas** is born of ignorance and that it deludes all embodied creatures. It binds fast, O **Bhārata**, by inadvertence, indolence, and sleep.

VERSE 14.9

सत्त्वं सुखे सञ्जयति रजः कर्मणि भारत ।
ज्ञानमावृत्य तु तमः प्रमादे सञ्जयत्युत ॥ ९ ॥

sattvaṁ sukhe sañjayati rajaḥ karmaṇi bhārata
jñānam āvṛitya tu tamaḥ pramāde sañjayaty uta

sattvam—mode of goodness; **sukhe**—to happiness; **sañjayati**—binds; **rajaḥ**—mode of passion; **karmaṇi**—toward actions; **bhārata**—Arjun, the son of Bharat; **jñānam**—wisdom; **āvṛitya**—clouds; **tu**—but; **tamaḥ**—mode of ignorance; **pramāde**—to delusion; **sañjayati**—binds; **uta**—indeed

Sattva binds one to happiness, and rajas to action, O Bhārata; whereas tamas veils knowledge and binds one to inadvertence.

VERSE 14.10

रजस्तमश्चाभिभूय सत्त्वं भवति भारत ।

रजः सत्त्वं तमश्चैव तमः सत्त्वं रजस्तथा ॥ 10 ॥

rajas tamaśh chābhibhūya sattvaṁ bhavati bhārata

rajaḥ sattvaṁ tamaśh chaiva tamaḥ sattvaṁ rajas tathā

rajaḥ—mode of passion; **tamaḥ**—mode of ignorance; **cha**—and; **abhibhūya**—prevails; **sattvam**—mode of goodness; **bhavati**—becomes; **bhārata**—Arjun, the son of Bharat; **rajaḥ**—mode of passion; **sattvam**—mode of goodness; **tamaḥ**—mode of ignorance; **cha**—and; **eva**—indeed; **tamaḥ**—mode of ignorance; **sattvam**—mode of goodness; **rajaḥ**—mode of passion; **tathā**—also

Sattva asserts itself by prevailing over rajas and tamas, O Bhārata; rajas asserts itself by prevailing over sattva and tamas; and tamas asserts itself by prevailing over sattva and rajas.